

Credit Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes the minimum credit standards applicants must meet to be considered for the Bank's standard consumer loan products. It applies to all personal installment loan applications processed through retail and digital origination channels.

2. Minimum Credit Standards

Applicants must meet the following minimum standards to be eligible for standard underwriting. Applicants who do not meet one or more of these standards must be evaluated under the Exception Policy (POL-EX-001).

Criterion	Minimum Standard
FICO score	620
Debt-to-Income (DTI) ratio	43% or lower
Verifiable employment history	24 months
Open, active credit tradelines	2 or more
Public records (bankruptcy, judgments)	None in past 24 months

3. Credit Score Tiers

Pricing and underwriting rigor scale with the applicant's FICO score band as follows:

FICO Range	Tier	Underwriting Treatment
720+	Prime	Streamlined underwriting; auto-approval eligible
660-719	Near-Prime	Standard underwriting
620-659	Subprime	Standard underwriting with income re-verification
Below 620	Deep Subprime	Not eligible under standard policy; see POL-EX-001

4. Debt-to-Income Requirements

The maximum allowable DTI ratio for standard approval is 43%. Applications with a DTI between 43% and 50% require senior underwriter sign-off per POL-AP-001 Section 3, and typically carry a rate add-on of

50-100 basis points to compensate for elevated repayment risk. Applications with DTI above 50% are not eligible for standard approval under any circumstance and must be declined or referred to the Exception Policy.

5. Employment and Income Verification

Applicants must demonstrate at least 24 months of verifiable employment history through pay stubs, W-2s, or direct employer verification. Applicants who cannot meet this requirement (e.g., recently self-employed, gig-economy income) may qualify under the Alternative Documentation Program, which requires 12 months of bank statements and a 10% larger down payment on secured products.

6. Credit History Requirements

Applicants must have at least 24 months of credit history reported to a national credit bureau. Thin-file applicants (fewer than 24 months of history) may be considered using the Alternative Credit Data Program, which incorporates rent and utility payment history where available.